Microsoft Project vs Planora

A side-by-side comparison with Microsoft Project Professional 2024

For planning, scheduling, tracking and reporting on a Windows PC, Planora does almost everything desktop Microsoft Project does, calculates the same dates, and opens Microsoft Project files, at no cost. Microsoft Project is still needed for saving .mpp files, running existing VBA macros and Microsoft's cloud services.

Free
vs US$680–1,130 or a monthly fee

188 / 188
task dates identical on real .mpp files

≈ 96%
of desktop Microsoft Project features (estimate)

0
accounts or internet needed

Feature	Planora 1.1	Microsoft Project
Price	Free	US$680–1,130 one-time, or US$30–55 per user per month
Platform	Windows 10/11	Windows desktop; web app with subscriptions
Account needed	No	Microsoft account or Microsoft 365
Works offline	Yes	Desktop yes, web no
Critical Path Method scheduling	Yes	Yes
Same dates on real .mpp files	188 / 188	—
Calendars, constraints, deadlines, splits, recurring tasks	Yes	Yes
Resources, costs, leveling, budgets	Yes	Yes
11 baselines, tracking, earned value	Yes	Yes
13 views incl. Network Diagram, Team Planner, Kanban	Yes	Yes
Custom fields, formulas, filters, groups, tables	Yes	Yes
Built-in reports and report designer	Yes	Yes
Print, PDF and image export	Yes	Yes
Command search for commands and tasks	Yes	Commands only
Open .mpp files	Yes	Yes
Save .mpp files	No (saves Microsoft Project XML)	Yes
Primavera P6 (XER / XML)	Open and save	No
Macros	Own VBA-like language	VBA
Project Online / Server, SharePoint, Teams, Power BI	No	Yes
Visual Reports to Excel / Visio	No	Yes

Accuracy check

Three plans saved by Microsoft Project itself were opened in Planora, recalculated from scratch, and compared task by task:

File	Tasks	Dates identical
Advanced Analytics plan	34	34 / 34
Commercial construction sample	144	144 / 144
Product development sample	10	10 / 10

Which one to choose

Choose Planora if you...	Choose Microsoft Project if you...
• need professional scheduling without paying for a licence • receive .mpp files and need to open, analyse and report them • work with Primavera P6 users • work offline or without Microsoft 365	• must send editable .mpp files to others • depend on existing VBA macros or Office add-ins • use Project Online, SharePoint or Teams for team updates • need portfolio management across many projects

Microsoft prices are US list prices (Microsoft 365 Project plans page, October 2026). Microsoft and Microsoft Project are trademarks of Microsoft Corporation; Planora is independent software.